

# TidyTuesday Week 35

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Tuesday 25<sup>th</sup> August, 2026

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# 1 Weekly Summary

## AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly digest of Randomly Yelling Numbers At Each Other, the only research program where the hypotheses are made up and the correlations don't matter. This week our tireless robot pulled two pairs of series out of the FRED grab bag, and I regret to inform you that neither of them is going to make us rich.

Monday-ish gave us the crown jewel: "Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies" versus "Diffusion Indexes, 3-Month Span: Total Nonfarm." Two phrases that, spoken aloud at a party, would clear the room in record time. And the result? An R-squared of about 0.0065. Sit down for this. That means we explained a heart-stopping 0.65 percent of the variation, leaving a mere 99.35 percent to the imagination. The p-value clocked in around 0.096, which is that special zone where a desperate grad student squints and mutters "marginally significant" while their advisor slowly leaves the building. The best part: after detrending, absolutely nothing changed – still weak, still not significant, still basically a flat line pretending to have a personality. So there wasn't even a trend-mirage to expose here. It's just genuinely, honestly, sincerely nothing. Refreshing, really.

Tuesday's contestant was even more spectacular, in the sense that it did not happen at all. We matched "Regular Seasonal Factors: Auto Production" against "U.S. Granted Patents: Reissue Patents Originating in Romania" – yes, Romania, reissue patents specifically, a data series with a popularity score of 1, meaning the only person who ever loved it was our robot. The regression returned a cascade of zeros and NaNs, which is statistics-speak for "I could not even." One series is monthly seasonal wiggles through 2027, the other is a trickle of annual Romanian patents ending in 2020, and when they tried to overlap they produced the numerical equivalent of two people waving at each other from different time zones. No R-squared, no F-statistic, no closure. Just void.

As always, the mandatory reminder: these pairs are chosen by a dice roll, not a theory. There is no causal claim, no rigorous inference, and no reason on Earth that Romanian reissue patents should have anything to do with auto seasonal factors. Spurious is the house style; a real relationship would frankly be a scandal. This week the numbers behaved themselves and refused to correlate, which is either deeply boring or a small victory for scientific integrity. See you next week, when we once again ask two unrelated strangers to slow dance and act surprised when they step on each other's feet.

## 2 Date: 2026-08-24

### Series ID: DTBOOXDFBANM

This series is titled Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies, Flow and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Monthly Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1980-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

### Series ID: SMS000000000000000022

This series is titled Diffusion Indexes, 3-Month Span: Total Nonfarm and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1991-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 17.

## 2.1 Raw Regression

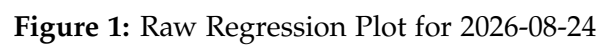
Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

|                         |                                  |                     |          |       |        |        |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------|----------|-------|--------|--------|
| Dep. Variable:          | value_fred_SMS000000000000000022 | R-squared:          | 0.007    |       |        |        |
| Model:                  | OLS                              | Adj. R-squared:     | 0.004    |       |        |        |
| Method:                 | Least Squares                    | F-statistic:        | 2.780    |       |        |        |
| Date:                   | Mon, 24 Aug 2026                 | Prob (F-statistic): | 0.0962   |       |        |        |
| Time:                   | 12:21:23                         | Log-Likelihood:     | -1980.1  |       |        |        |
| No. Observations:       | 425                              | AIC:                | 3964.    |       |        |        |
| Df Residuals:           | 423                              | BIC:                | 3972.    |       |        |        |
| Df Model:               | 1                                |                     |          |       |        |        |
| Covariance Type:        | nonrobust                        |                     |          |       |        |        |
|                         | coef                             | std err             | t        | P>  t | [0.025 | 0.975] |
| const                   | 76.2916                          | 1.244               | 61.331   | 0.000 | 73.847 | 78.737 |
| value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM | 0.0009                           | 0.001               | 1.667    | 0.096 | -0.000 | 0.002  |
| Omnibus:                | 115.402                          | Durbin-Watson:      | 0.217    |       |        |        |
| Prob(Omnibus):          | 0.000                            | Jarque-Bera (JB):   | 214.702  |       |        |        |
| Skew:                   | -1.569                           | Prob(JB):           | 2.39e-47 |       |        |        |
| Kurtosis:               | 4.511                            | Cond. No.           | 2.40e+03 |       |        |        |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.4e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



## 2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

|                          |                                           |                            |         |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------|----------------------------|---------|
| <b>Dep. Variable:</b>    | value_fred_SMS00000000000000022_detrended | <b>R-squared:</b>          | 0.006   |
| <b>Model:</b>            | OLS                                       | <b>Adj. R-squared:</b>     | 0.004   |
| <b>Method:</b>           | Least Squares                             | <b>F-statistic:</b>        | 2.758   |
| <b>Date:</b>             | Mon, 24 Aug 2026                          | <b>Prob (F-statistic):</b> | 0.0975  |
| <b>Time:</b>             | 12:21:24                                  | <b>Log-Likelihood:</b>     | -1980.1 |
| <b>No. Observations:</b> | 425                                       | <b>AIC:</b>                | 3964.   |
| <b>Df Residuals:</b>     | 423                                       | <b>BIC:</b>                | 3972.   |
| <b>Df Model:</b>         | 1                                         |                            |         |
| <b>Covariance Type:</b>  | nonrobust                                 |                            |         |

|                                          | coef     | std err | t        | P>  t | [0.025 | 0.975] |
|------------------------------------------|----------|---------|----------|-------|--------|--------|
| <b>const</b>                             | 4.49e-14 | 1.242   | 3.62e-14 | 1.000 | -2.441 | 2.441  |
| <b>value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM_detrended</b> | 0.0009   | 0.001   | 1.661    | 0.098 | -0.000 | 0.002  |

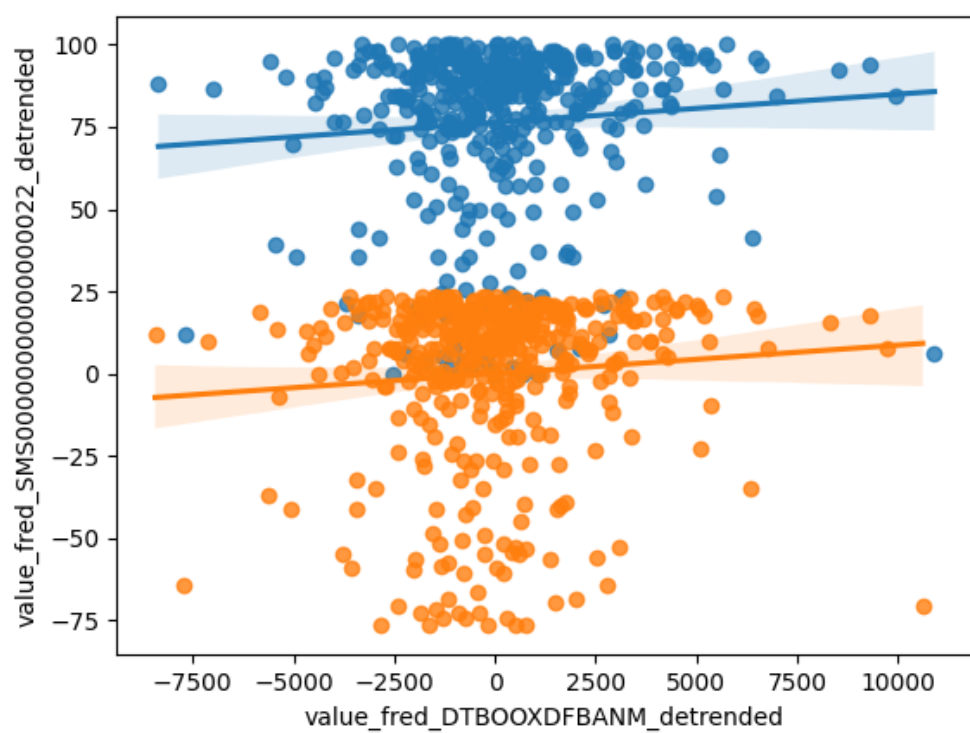
  

|                       |         |                          |          |
|-----------------------|---------|--------------------------|----------|
| <b>Omnibus:</b>       | 115.439 | <b>Durbin-Watson:</b>    | 0.217    |
| <b>Prob(Omnibus):</b> | 0.000   | <b>Jarque-Bera (JB):</b> | 214.833  |
| <b>Skew:</b>          | -1.569  | <b>Prob(JB):</b>         | 2.24e-47 |
| <b>Kurtosis:</b>      | 4.513   | <b>Cond. No.</b>         | 2.39e+03 |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.39e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



**Figure 2:** Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-24

### 3 Date: 2026-08-25

#### Series ID: G17MVSFAUTOS

This series is titled Regular Seasonal Factors: Auto Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

#### Series ID: PATENT4NROREISSUE

This series is titled U.S. Granted Patents: Reissue Patents Originating in Romania and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1993-01-01 and the observation end date is 2020-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

### 3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

|                          |                              |                            |      |
|--------------------------|------------------------------|----------------------------|------|
| <b>Dep. Variable:</b>    | value_fred_PATENT4NROREISSUE | <b>R-squared:</b>          | nan  |
| <b>Model:</b>            | OLS                          | <b>Adj. R-squared:</b>     | nan  |
| <b>Method:</b>           | Least Squares                | <b>F-statistic:</b>        | nan  |
| <b>Date:</b>             | Tue, 25 Aug 2026             | <b>Prob (F-statistic):</b> | nan  |
| <b>Time:</b>             | 12:22:02                     | <b>Log-Likelihood:</b>     | inf  |
| <b>No. Observations:</b> | 25                           | <b>AIC:</b>                | -inf |
| <b>Df Residuals:</b>     | 23                           | <b>BIC:</b>                | -inf |
| <b>Df Model:</b>         | 1                            |                            |      |
| <b>Covariance Type:</b>  | nonrobust                    |                            |      |

|                                | coef | std err | t   | P>  t | [0.025 | 0.975] |
|--------------------------------|------|---------|-----|-------|--------|--------|
| <b>const</b>                   | 0    | 0       | nan | nan   | 0      | 0      |
| <b>value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS</b> | 0    | 0       | nan | nan   | 0      | 0      |

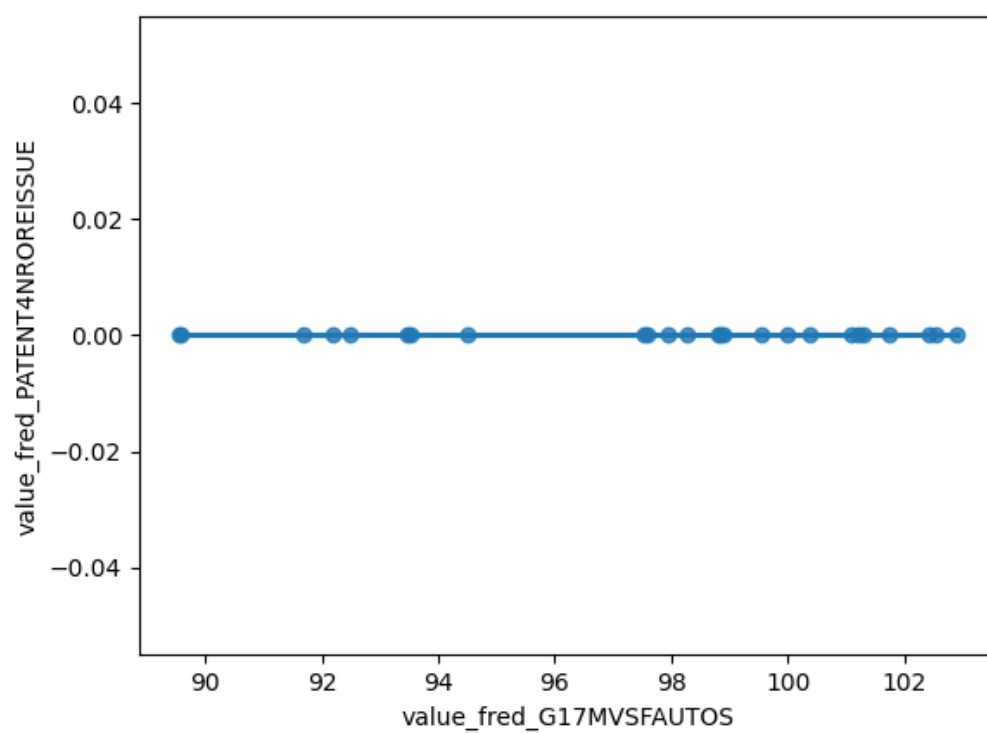
  

|                       |     |                          |          |
|-----------------------|-----|--------------------------|----------|
| <b>Omnibus:</b>       | nan | <b>Durbin-Watson:</b>    | nan      |
| <b>Prob(Omnibus):</b> | nan | <b>Jarque-Bera (JB):</b> | nan      |
| <b>Skew:</b>          | nan | <b>Prob(JB):</b>         | nan      |
| <b>Kurtosis:</b>      | nan | <b>Cond. No.</b>         | 2.33e+03 |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.33e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



**Figure 3:** Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-25



### 3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

|                          |                                         |                            |      |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------------------|----------------------------|------|
| <b>Dep. Variable:</b>    | value_fred_PATENT4NRROREISSUE_detrended | <b>R-squared:</b>          | nan  |
| <b>Model:</b>            | OLS                                     | <b>Adj. R-squared:</b>     | nan  |
| <b>Method:</b>           | Least Squares                           | <b>F-statistic:</b>        | nan  |
| <b>Date:</b>             | Tue, 25 Aug 2026                        | <b>Prob (F-statistic):</b> | nan  |
| <b>Time:</b>             | 12:22:03                                | <b>Log-Likelihood:</b>     | inf  |
| <b>No. Observations:</b> | 25                                      | <b>AIC:</b>                | -inf |
| <b>Df Residuals:</b>     | 23                                      | <b>BIC:</b>                | -inf |
| <b>Df Model:</b>         | 1                                       |                            |      |
| <b>Covariance Type:</b>  | nonrobust                               |                            |      |

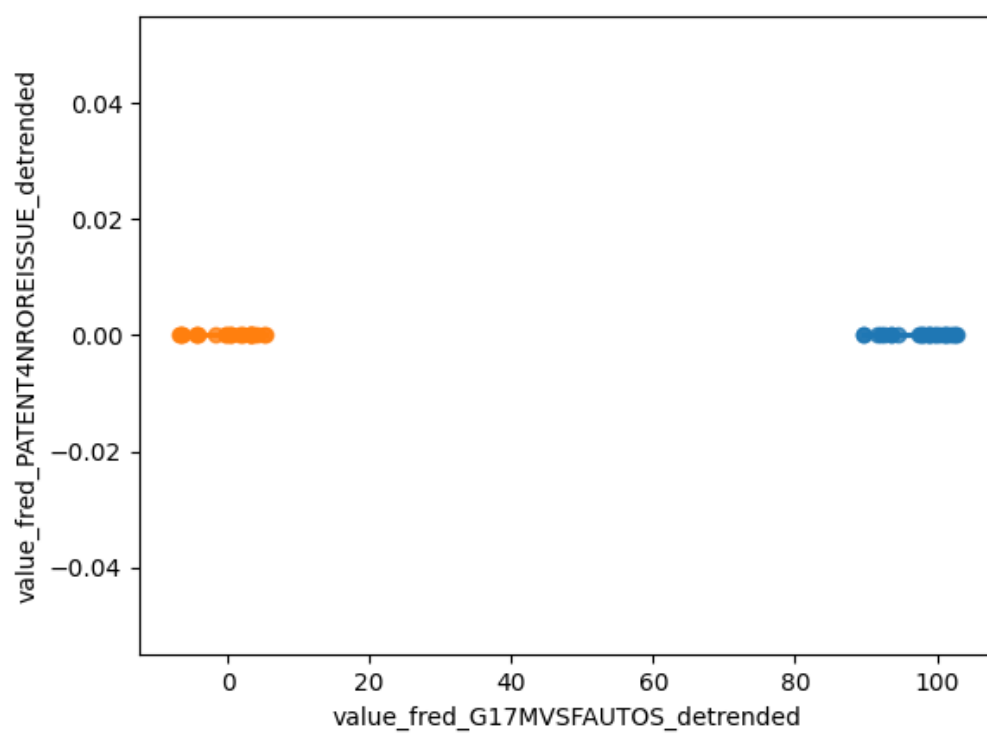
|                                          | coef | std err | t   | P>  t | [0.025 | 0.975] |
|------------------------------------------|------|---------|-----|-------|--------|--------|
| <b>const</b>                             | 0    | 0       | nan | nan   | 0      | 0      |
| <b>value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS_detrended</b> | 0    | 0       | nan | nan   | 0      | 0      |

|                       |     |                          |      |
|-----------------------|-----|--------------------------|------|
| <b>Omnibus:</b>       | nan | <b>Durbin-Watson:</b>    | nan  |
| <b>Prob(Omnibus):</b> | nan | <b>Jarque-Bera (JB):</b> | nan  |
| <b>Skew:</b>          | nan | <b>Prob(JB):</b>         | nan  |
| <b>Kurtosis:</b>      | nan | <b>Cond. No.</b>         | 3.92 |

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.



**Figure 4:** Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-25